



Google and FB's New Cable

Google and FB to lay down a new subsea cable to improve internet connectivity across Asia. <https://dgit.in/sep21-71>



Apple working on nex-gen chip

Apple may launch devices powered by the M2 chip next year. <https://dgit.in/sep21-72>

OnePlus Buds Pro

Feature-packed beast!

OnePlus has come out with its latest true wireless offering, the OnePlus Buds Pro. Sporting the 'Pro' moniker, the OnePlus Buds Pro is a feature-packed pair of TWS earphones complete with Active Noise Cancellation, pressure-sensitive controls, Qi wireless charging, app support, and much more. Let's see how OnePlus' newest TWS offering fares in our full review.

BUILD AND COMFORT

Simplistic yet elegant. These are the words that come to mind when you look at the OnePlus Buds Pro. The earbuds are extremely lightweight and are supremely comfortable to wear. The buds are part matte and part glossy, giving them an aesthetically pleasing dual tone look.

The charging case has a matte finish except for the OnePlus logo, which is glossy. Again very simplistic and classy. The case is pretty flat so it is easily portable and doesn't bulge out too much from pockets.

PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus Buds Pro houses 11mm dynamic drivers and support SBC, AAC and LHDC codecs. LHDC supports hi-res, low-latency audio but few phones can use this codec.

Coming to the sound signature of the OnePlus Buds Pro, these earbuds have a pleasing sound signature for the most part, that not only highlights the bass, but also the mids. You get a bass-rich experience with punchy and impactful low bass response. There can be slight boominess in the bass at times though. Also the mids can sometimes get shrouded due to auditory masking.

The upper mids and highs in this area are very prominent in the mix. This is excellent in tracks such as *Heat Waves* by *Glass Animals*, where the bass is extremely thumpy but the



BUILD	85
FEATURES	86
PERFORMANCE	70
VALUE	68

vocals are also clear. Overall, these buds are enjoyable to listen to and bass-lovers will really love the sound signature, however, at a similar price, the Oppo Enco X definitely provides a more balanced sound signature.

The OnePlus Buds Pro houses a triple microphone setup. During our testing process, we found the microphone to be pretty mediocre. In an indoor setting, the voice sounds a bit muffled and garbled. As for wireless connectivity, the OnePlus Buds Pro is powered by the latest Bluetooth 5.2.

FEATURES

The OnePlus Buds Pro are what you would call feature-packed TWS earphones. The OnePlus Buds Pro comes with hybrid ANC in three modes. Users can choose between Extreme, Faint and Smart mode. Smart mode makes use of the Smart Adaptive Noise Cancellation tech that automatically responds to your environment and adjusts the noise cancelling level accordingly. With ANC on, low, constant sounds such as an AC's hum was suppressed to a level where we almost couldn't hear it at all. The earbuds also have a Transparency Mode feature that worked as expected.

The earphones have pressure sensitive controls that can also be used to

control music playback and calls. The controls took us some getting used to, but over time we preferred these over the traditional touch controls.

You can customise some of these controls via the HeyMelody app for Android and iOS devices, or via the native Bluetooth settings on OnePlus devices. Apart from touch controls, users can tweak around with more features such as Zen Mode, OnePlus Audio ID and more, within the app.

Lastly, the buds not only come with IP55 dust and water resistant rating on the earbuds themselves, but also have an IPX4 water resistance rating for the charging case as well. The buds even come with Qi wireless charging for the case.

BATTERY LIFE

When we tested the battery life, the buds lasted for 4 hours and 50 minutes with ANC turned on, at 60-70 percent volume. The case was able to charge the buds 4 to 5 times over pretty easily as well.

VERDICT

The OnePlus Buds Pro are, no doubt, a solid pair of mid-range truly wireless earphones complete with features such as Active Noise Cancellation, app support, Qi wireless charging, long battery life, and much more. However, the OnePlus Buds Pro is overshadowed by some of its competitors. The Oppo Enco X offers a more balanced sound signature, while the Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro offers not only better sound but slightly better ANC.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 4.35g (earbuds), 52g (charging case) | DRIVERS: 11 mm dynamic | DRIVER SENSITIVITY: 102 dB ± 3dB @ 1 KHz | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz - 20,000Hz | IP RATING: IP55 (earbuds), IPX4 (charging case) | BLUETOOTH VERSION: Bluetooth 5.2 | CODECS SUPPORTED: SBC, AAC, LHDC | BATTERY LIFE (EARBUDS): 5 hours (ANC on), 7 hours (ANC off) | BATTERY LIFE (WITH CHARGING CASE): 28 hours (ANC on), 38 hours (ANC off) | FAST CHARGE: Warp charge - 10 mins for 10 hours

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